
HS 503: German Literature from World War II to Reunification

Course Code	HS 503
Course Name	German Literature from World War II to Reunification
L-T-P-C	3-0-0-3
Prerequisites	None
Intended for	Outside Discipline/ Free Elective for MA, UG (3rd and 4th year)
Mutual Exclusion	None
Approval	52nd BoA (Nov 2023)

Course Contents

- **Unit 1: Truemmer-literature – The Zero Hour** (8 Lectures)
 - Immediate consequences of World War II and Holocaust
 - Stunde Null
 - Trauma and memories of the War and Holocaust
 - Wolfgang Borchert, Paul Celan, Guenter Eich et al.
- **Unit 2: Literature from a divided Germany** (9 Lectures)
 - Division of Germany
 - Vergangenheitsbewältigung – coming to terms with the past
 - Inner Emigration
 - Gruppe
 - Heinrich Boell, Guenter Grass, Paul Celan et al.
- **Unit 3: Exile Literature** (9 Lectures)
 - Literary texts from authors of East Germany or GDR
 - Division of Germany and socio-political consequences thereof
 - Life in exile and under communist surveillance in GDR
 - Question of Heimatlosigkeit (homelessness)
 - Bertolt Brecht, Christa Wolf, Wolf Biermann et al
- **Unit 4: Jewish authors and survivors of the Holocaust** (8 Lectures)
 - Select Jewish authors who have lived and survived the Holocaust
 - Victim's perspective of the Third Reich
 - Rose Auslaender, Nelly Sachs, Paul Celan et al
- **Unit 5: Re-unification of Germany (Wendeliteratur)** (8 lecture Lectures)
 - Fall of the Berlin Wall (die Wende)
 - Immediate after-effects of the re-unification of Germany
 - Identity crisis of the citizens

Text Books

1. Peter Demetz, **Post War German Literature. A Critical Introduction**, Pegasus, 1970
2. Ingo R. Stoehr, **German Literature of the Twentieth Century**, Camden House, 2001

References

Readings

1. Wolfgang Borchert: The Kitchen Clock (Die Kuechenuhr, 1947)
2. Paul Celan: Death Fugue (Todesfuge, 1948)
3. Heinrich Boell: The Train Was on Time (Der Zug war puenktlich, 1949)
4. Guenter Eich: Inventory (Inventur, 1947)
5. Wolfdietrich Schnurr: On The Run (Auf der Flucht, 1950)
6. Bertolt Brecht: On The Term Emigrants/ Ueber die Bezeichnung Emigranten, 1937/ To Those Who Follow in Our Wake (An die Nachgeborenen, 1939)
7. Christa Wolf: Der geteilte Himmel, 1963 (Divided Heaven: Film 1964)
8. Anna Seghers: The Seventh Cross (Das siebte Kreuz, 1942)
9. Nelly Sachs: In the Houses of Death (In den Wohnungen des Todes, 1947)
10. Thomas Brussig: Heroes Like Us (Helden wie wir, 1995)
11. Christa Wolf: What Remains (Was bleibt, 1990)
12. Sven Regener: Berlin Blues (Text or Film: 2003) (Herr Lehmann, 2001)
13. Rose Auslaender: The Luck (Das Glueck, 1939)
14. Johannes Bobrowski: Shadowland/ The Latvian Autumn (1994)
15. Marcel Reich-Ranicki: Videos from Literarische Quartett (Youtube)
16. Hans Egon Holthusen: A Literature in Transition. Main Currents of Post War German Writing, The Atlantic
17. Aaron Denis Horton: Catastrophe and Identity in Post War German Literature, 2005

Films

1. Schindler's List (1994)
2. The Boy in Striped Pyjamas (2008)
3. The Pianist (2002)
4. The Lives of Others (2006)
5. The Tin Drum (1979)
6. The Reader (2008)
7. Downfall (2004)
8. Enemy at the Gates (2001)